



Saint Columban College
College of Computing Studies
Pagadian City



Log Hunt

Log Hunt 



Easy

General Skills

picoMini by CMU-Africa

browser_webshell_solvable

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Description

Our server seems to be leaking pieces of a secret flag in its logs. The parts are scattered and sometimes repeated. Can you reconstruct the original flag?

Download the [logs](#) and figure out the full flag from the fragments.

Hints 

1 2

You can use `grep` to filter only matching lines from the log.

22,884 users solved



95%

Liked



Author: The Analyst: Hyposelenia

Challenge: Log Hunt

Category: General Skills

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I. Objective

The objective of this task was to reconstruct a hidden picoCTF flag by locating and combining multiple flag fragments that were scattered throughout a server log file.

II. Background

In cybersecurity, log files often contain large amounts of information such as system messages, warnings, and errors. Sometimes, sensitive data can accidentally appear inside logs.

This challenge simulates a real-world scenario where pieces of a secret are leaked across log entries and must be identified and reconstructed efficiently.

III. Tool Used

- **Oracle VirtualBox (Kali Linux)** – Used as the Linux environment to run the challenge
- **Linux Terminal** – Used to execute commands
- **grep** – Filters output to show only lines that match a keyword

IV. Methodology

1. The `server.log` file provided by the challenge was accessed in the Kali Linux environment.
2. Instead of manually reading the entire log file, the following efficient command was used:

```
grep FLAGPART server.log
```

3. This command displayed **all log entries containing flag fragments**.
4. Duplicate fragments were ignored, and each unique fragment was copied.
5. The fragments were combined in the correct order to form the complete picoCTF flag.



V. Result

picoCTF{us3_y0urlinux_sk1lls_cedfa5fb}

```
(kali㉿kali)-[/media/sf_Downloaded_Cybersecfiles]
$ grep FLAGPART server.log
[1990-08-09 10:00:10] INFO FLAGPART: picoCTF{us3_
[1990-08-09 10:02:55] INFO FLAGPART: y0urlinux_
[1990-08-09 10:05:54] INFO FLAGPART: sk1lls_
[1990-08-09 10:05:55] INFO FLAGPART: sk1lls_
[1990-08-09 10:10:54] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
[1990-08-09 10:10:58] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
[1990-08-09 10:11:06] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
[1990-08-09 11:04:27] INFO FLAGPART: picoCTF{us3_
[1990-08-09 11:04:29] INFO FLAGPART: picoCTF{us3_
[1990-08-09 11:04:37] INFO FLAGPART: picoCTF{us3_
[1990-08-09 11:09:16] INFO FLAGPART: y0urlinux_
[1990-08-09 11:09:19] INFO FLAGPART: y0urlinux_
[1990-08-09 11:12:40] INFO FLAGPART: sk1lls_
[1990-08-09 11:12:45] INFO FLAGPART: sk1lls_
[1990-08-09 11:16:58] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
[1990-08-09 11:16:59] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
[1990-08-09 11:17:00] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
[1990-08-09 12:19:23] INFO FLAGPART: picoCTF{us3_
[1990-08-09 12:19:29] INFO FLAGPART: picoCTF{us3_
[1990-08-09 12:19:32] INFO FLAGPART: picoCTF{us3_
[1990-08-09 12:23:43] INFO FLAGPART: y0urlinux_
[1990-08-09 12:23:45] INFO FLAGPART: y0urlinux_
[1990-08-09 12:23:53] INFO FLAGPART: y0urlinux_
[1990-08-09 12:25:32] INFO FLAGPART: sk1lls_
[1990-08-09 12:28:45] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
[1990-08-09 12:28:49] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
[1990-08-09 12:28:52] INFO FLAGPART: cedfa5fb}
```

VI. Explanation

Initially, the keyword picoCTF was used to locate the first part of the flag inside the log file. After identifying that each fragment was labeled with the keyword FLAGPART, the search was refined.

While multiple commands such as:

grep picoCTF server.log

grep FLAGPART server.log

can be used to locate different parts of the flag, the **most efficient approach** is:

grep FLAGPART server.log

This single command filters the log file and displays **all flag fragments at once**, avoiding unnecessary output such as warnings, errors, and debug messages.



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By viewing all fragments together and ignoring repeated entries, the full flag can be reconstructed quickly and accurately without manual scrolling or excessive searching.

VII. Conclusion

This challenge demonstrates the importance of efficient log analysis techniques. By identifying consistent markers like FLAGPART and using the grep command effectively, large log files can be analyzed quickly.

The task reinforces the value of pattern recognition and command-line filtering, both of which are essential skills in cybersecurity and digital forensics.

— **The Analyst: Hyposelenia**